

CWE AI Working Group: New Entry Subgroup

December 5, 2025

Attendance

Steve Christey

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Sasha Romanosky

Alec Summers

Agenda

- Status Updates
- CWE Release Information
- Work Planning

Meeting Notes:

Status Updates

Steve and Alec discussed the delay of the new CWE version release, now tentatively set for December 11th. Alec emphasized the importance of meeting this date due to the inclusion of the new Top 25 and increased coordination requirements.

Steve noted that this release is more complex than usual due to the integration of the new Top 25, requiring additional team coordination.

CWE Release Information

Steve provided an overview of five current AI-related CWE submissions, noting that most involve modifications to existing entries rather than new AI-specific proposals. He outlined the ongoing review process and next steps for each submission. Steve suggested using the monthly new entry review series to address all submissions.

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- **ANSI Escape Code Injection Submission:** Identified as a key submission, aiming to develop a demonstrative example and potentially update an existing CWE entry.
- **Other AI-Related Submissions:** Additional submissions include bias in AI models (Kurt Seyfried), a configuration issue with MCP clients, and a language translation-related weakness. Each requires initial review and formal feedback.
- **Consensus on Bias Submissions:** General agreement that bias in AI models typically does not qualify as a CWE or CVE, though Sasha shared a research example linking bias to increased vulnerabilities. Steve requested a reference link for further review.

ANSI Escape Sequences in LLM Tokenizers:

Steve, Erick, and Sasha discussed Erick's submission on ANSI escape sequences in LLM tokenizers, exploring mechanics, attack scenarios, and implications for CWE-150: Improper Neutralization of Escape, Meta, or Control Sequences. Steve suggested integrating Erick's background details and technical description into the CWE entry.

- **Technical Explanation of Tokenizer Vulnerability:** Erick explained how certain ANSI escape codes are represented as single tokens in LLM tokenizers, making them easier to output and potentially weaponize.
- **Attack Scenarios and Demonstrative Example Planning:** The group discussed scenarios like log file manipulation and terminal hijacking, agreeing to create a demonstrative example (e.g., flashing text or DNS exfiltration).
- **Generalization and Scope of Vulnerability:** Sasha questioned whether the vulnerability should be generalized to all tokenizers or remain specific to LLMs. The group agreed to keep the CWE description broad while using specific examples.
- **Process for Submission Acceptance and Next Steps:** Steve outlined the process for formally accepting Erick's submission, moving it to the “details requested” phase, consulting the community for references, and improving CWE-150 based on both AI-specific and general escape sequence injection submissions.

Work Planning

Steve announced that the modification subgroup will not meet for the next several weeks due to the holiday season, making this the last meeting of the year. He encouraged continued discussion on the CDR.

Action Items:

- **CWE-150 Update and Demonstrative Example:** Develop and submit an AI/LLM-specific demonstrative example for CWE-150, focusing on ANSI escape sequence

injection via LLM tokenizers, and select the most appropriate reference for inclusion. (Erick, Steve)

- **CWE-150 Entry Improvement:** Expand CWE-150 to include scenarios and background details about terminal escape sequence attacks, referencing both recent AI-specific submissions and the general ANSI escape sequence submission from a year ago. (Steve)
- **Review of Previous Meeting Discussion:** Review the previous meeting transcript to clarify points where bias in AI models was considered security relevant and summarize findings for the group. (Steve)